

100 ADVANCED C1–C2 ENGLISH ACTIVITIES

Practical English Usage (Michael Swan) & English Pronunciation in Use Advanced (Hewings)

Module 1: Tricky Grammatical Usage & Boundary Cases (Practical English Usage)

Activity #1: Distinguishing 'As' vs. 'Like' in Executive & Formal Register

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Usage precision in comparisons & roles | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Usage Distinction

Objective: Distinguish strictly between prepositional 'like' (similarity) and 'as' (role/function or conjunction) in corporate contexts.

Instructions: Correct or refine sentences using 'as' or 'like' according to formal British/International standards.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. He worked like the interim CEO for six months. 2. Like I stated yesterday, revenues are rebounding.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. He worked as the interim CEO for six months. (role) 2. As I stated yesterday, revenues are rebounding. (conjunction introducing a clause)'

Activity #2: Differentiating 'All' vs. 'Every' vs. 'Whole' in Statistical Statements

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Determiner precision in quantitative reports | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Determiner Selection

Objective: Select and deploy 'all', 'every', or 'whole' correctly based on countable vs. uncountable noun structures and totalities.

Instructions: Complete sentences with the correct determiner based on subtle usage constraints.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. _____ company in the conglomerate reported growth. 2. The _____ management board resigned after the audit.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Every company in the conglomerate reported growth. 2. The whole management board resigned after the audit.'

Activity #3: Navigating Reciprocal Pronouns: 'Each Other' vs. 'One Another'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Reciprocal pronoun usage in multi-party contexts | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Reciprocal Pronoun Precision

Objective: Apply 'each other' (two entities) vs. 'one another' (three or more entities) in legal and corporate agreements.

Instructions: Edit a contractual clause to ensure precise reciprocal pronoun usage across multi-subsidiary partners.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'The two founding partners agreed to indemnify one another, while the five regional directors pledged to support each other.'

Expected Output: Output: 'The two founding partners agreed to indemnify each other, while the five regional directors pledged to support one another.'

Activity #4: Mastering Inverted Negative Adverbials: 'Hardly...When' vs. 'No Sooner...Than'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Formal clause inversion & time conjunctions | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Syntactic Inversion

Objective: Deploy 'hardly/scarcely...when' and 'no sooner...than' with correct inverted past perfect structures in high-level prose.

Instructions: Transform standard temporal sequences into dramatic, inverted formal statements.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'As soon as the merger was finalized, regulatory opposition emerged.'

Expected Output: Output: 'No sooner had the merger been finalized than regulatory opposition emerged. / Hardly had the merger been finalized when regulatory opposition emerged.'

Activity #5: Deconstructing 'Supposed to' vs. 'Meant to' in Policy Expectations

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Modal idiom nuance & implicit obligations | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Modal Idiom Precision

Objective: Express expected behavior, general reputation, or unfulfilled expectations using 'supposed to' and 'meant to'.

Instructions: Write two distinct statements showing (a) a scheduled rule and (b) an intended functional design.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft sentences for (a) employee arrival times and (b) a software feature design goal.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Employees are supposed to log into the security portal by 08:30. 2. This algorithm was meant to reduce processing latency by 40%.'

Activity #6: Disambiguating 'Used to' vs. 'Be/Get Used to' in Career Transitions

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Habitual past vs. acclimation structure | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Structural Disambiguation

Objective: Differentiate between bare infinitive 'used to' (past state/habit) and gerund-prepositional 'be/get used to' (acclimation).

Instructions: Draft a narrative paragraph on executive relocation using both structures accurately.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'I used to manage a small localized team in London, but after moving to Tokyo, I had to get used to leading a multicultural remote workforce across four time zones.'

Activity #7: Causal Prepositions: 'Due to' vs. 'Owing to' in Financial Reporting

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Adjectival vs. adverbial causal prepositions | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Causal Preposition Audit

Objective: Apply 'due to' (adjectival, modifying nouns after 'be') vs. 'owing to' (adverbial, modifying verbs/clauses) in formal finance.

Instructions: Audit and correct a CFO's report excerpt for precise causal preposition usage.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Owing to the CEO's resignation, stock prices fell. The drop in profits was owing to supply disruptions.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Owing to the CEO's resignation, stock prices fell. (correct: adverbial modifier) The drop in profits was due to supply disruptions. (correct: adjectival complement after 'was')'

Activity #8: Hypothetical Manner: 'As though' vs. 'As if' with Subjunctive Mood

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Counterfactual manner clauses | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Subjunctive Manner Clauses

Objective: Use 'as though' and 'as if' with past subjunctive (*were*) or past perfect to express unreal counterfactual states.

Instructions: Construct a diplomatic observation analyzing a competitor's aggressive market stance.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Describe a competitor acting with supreme confidence despite clear insolvency.'

Expected Output: Output: 'The competitor operates as though they were completely immune to liquidity constraints, spending aggressively despite severe debt obligations.'

Activity #9: Grading Modifiers: 'Fairly' vs. 'Quite' vs. 'Rather' vs. 'Pretty'

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Degree adverb calibration across formal/informal register | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Degree Modifier Calibration

Objective: Calibrate degree modifiers according to register, positive/negative adjectives, and British/American nuance.

Instructions: Rank four corporate evaluations from mildest praise to strong endorsement using 'fairly', 'quite', 'rather', and 'pretty'.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Evaluate a strategic report's quality across four register levels.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Informal: It is pretty good. 2. Mild formal: It is fairly thorough. 3. Standard formal: It is quite impressive. 4. Unexpected/strong: It is rather remarkable.'

Activity #10: Negative Adverbial Nuances: 'Barely' vs. 'Scarcely' vs. 'Hardly'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Degree & time limit adverbials in academic prose | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Negative Adverbial Selection

Objective: Distinguish subtle collocational and semantic boundaries between 'barely' (quantity/amount), 'scarcely' (time/expectation), and 'hardly' (degree/ability).

Instructions: Insert the most precise adverbial into three academic sentences.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. There was _____ enough budget for research. 2. He had _____ entered the room when the alarms sounded. 3. I can _____ believe the thesis passed.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. There was barely enough budget for research. 2. He had scarcely entered the room when the alarms sounded. 3. I can hardly believe the thesis passed.'

Module 2: Register Shifts, Style & Formality Nuances (Practical English Usage)

Activity #11: Subjunctive vs. Modal Equivalences in High-Level Resolutions

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Formal mandative subjunctive vs. 'should' infinitive | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Mandative Subjunctive Formulation

Objective: Construct formal board resolutions using mandative subjunctive (*that X be done*) and contrast with 'should' formulations.

Instructions: Draft a formal corporate resolution requiring an immediate external security audit.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft resolution: The committee insists that an external auditor inspect the accounts immediately.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Subjunctive: The board resolves that an external auditor inspect the financial records immediately. / Modal equivalent: The board resolves that an external auditor should inspect the financial records immediately.'

Activity #12: Formal Omission of Relative Pronouns & Preposition Fronting

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Syntactic compression in legal & academic prose | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Preposition Fronting & Register Shift

Objective: Move prepositions to the front of relative clauses (*in which*, *to whom*) and evaluate where relative pronoun omission is permitted.

Instructions: Rewrite an informal contract clause into elevated legal register.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'The consultant we spoke to about the software we bought signed the NDA.'

Expected Output: Output: 'The consultant with whom we conferred regarding the software purchased signed the non-disclosure agreement.'

Activity #13: Spoken Ellipsis in Executive Briefings: Dropping Pronouns & Auxiliaries

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Natural executive brevity & conversational reduction | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Spoken Ellipsis Conversion

Objective: Apply natural spoken ellipsis (omitting initial pronouns/auxiliaries e.g., '[Have you] Got a minute?', '[It] Sounds good') in rapid executive updates without sounding ungrammatical.

Instructions: Transform formal written status reports into natural, concise spoken briefing lines.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'I have checked the figures. They look accurate. Do you need anything else?'

Expected Output: Output: 'Checked the figures. Look accurate. Need anything else?'

Activity #14: Avoiding Informal Slip-ups in Executive Correspondence

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Auditing register breakdowns in corporate emails | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Register Slip-Up Editing

Objective: Identify and replace informal collocations, phrasal verbs, and conversational fillers with executive vocabulary.

Instructions: Audit an email draft to the Chief Risk Officer and replace three register slip-ups.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft: 'We ran into some big issues with the compliance check, but we got over them quickly.''

Expected Output: Output: 'Audit: 'We encountered significant challenges during the compliance audit, but we resolved them expeditiously.''

Activity #15: Impersonal Passive Reporting Structures in Journalism

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Distancing devices & objective news reporting | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Impersonal Passive Reporting

Objective: Deploy impersonal passive reporting structures (*It is understood that...*, *X is alleged to have...*) to maintain objective journalistic distance.

Instructions: Transform an unverified insider leak into a balanced, professional press report.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Insider claim: 'The CEO stole funds and will resign tomorrow.''

Expected Output: Output: 'It is reported that funds were misappropriated, and the Chief Executive is alleged to be stepping down tomorrow.'

Activity #16: Distance Markers & Tactful Hedging in Diplomatic Rejections

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Softening refusal via distance markers | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Diplomatic Distance Framing

Objective: Use distance markers (*It would appear that*, *I am led to believe*, *Regrettably, circumstances prevent*) to deliver diplomatic rejections.

Instructions: Write a diplomatic rejection letter to an international grant applicant.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Regrettably, it would appear that your proposal does not fully align with our current strategic funding priorities; consequently, we are unable to approve grant funding at this juncture.'

Activity #17: Euphemism & Softening Vocabulary in HR & Crisis Management

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Tactful phrasing in sensitive corporate updates | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Corporate Euphemism Transformation

Objective: Replace blunt terms (*fire*, *pay cuts*, *failing*) with professional corporate euphemisms (*restructure*, *compensation adjustments*, *underperforming*).

Instructions: Re-draft a harsh HR announcement regarding corporate downsizing.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Re-draft: "We are firing 200 workers because our sales are terrible."'

Expected Output: Output: 'Re-draft: "To optimize operational efficiency following recent revenue contractions, we are initiating a workforce reduction affecting 200 positions."'

Activity #18: Particle Movement & Register Calibration in Phrasal Verbs

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Formal Latinate replacement vs. separable particle placement | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Phrasal Verb Register Calibration

Objective: Demonstrate when to replace phrasal verbs with single Latinate verbs and where particle placement alters rhythm and register.

Instructions: Upgrade three phrasal verb sentences into formal written prose.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. They put off the board meeting. 2. She pointed out the defect. 3. We brought about major reforms.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. The board meeting was postponed. 2. She highlighted the defect. 3. We instituted major reforms.'

Activity #19: Polite Request Hedging: Past Tense & Continuous Aspect

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Attitudinal distancing using past continuous modal structures | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Attitudinal Distancing

Objective: Use past simple and past continuous forms (*I was wondering*, *I was hoping*, *Did you want*) to soften requests and inquiries.

Instructions: Construct three polite executive requests to a senior stakeholder.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft requests for (a) a schedule change, (b) a budget review, and (c) feedback.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. I was wondering if we might reschedule our briefing to Thursday. 2. I was hoping you had a moment to review the financial projections. 3. Did you want to discuss the draft before the board meeting?'

Activity #20: Formal Prepositional Locutions in Corporate Policy

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Legalistic prepositional phrases | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Formal Prepositional Locutions

Objective: Utilize complex formal prepositional locutions (*in accordance with*, *notwithstanding*, *with effect from*, *in lieu of*) in corporate governance policy.

Instructions: Draft a policy statement regarding annual leave carryover.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Notwithstanding prior department guidelines, and in accordance with the revised Labor Act, unused annual leave may be converted into cash payments in lieu of rollover days, with effect from January 1st.'

Module 3: Prepositional Precision & Confusing Lexical Pairs (Practical English Usage)

Activity #21: Temporal & Positional Prepositions: 'At the end' vs. 'In the end'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Fixed prepositional contrast | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Prepositional Pair Selection

Objective: Distinguish 'at the end' (point in time/place) from 'in the end' (eventual outcome/finally) in strategic reports.

Instructions: Insert the correct prepositional phrase into executive summaries.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. ____ of Q4, total revenue surged. 2. After months of negotiation, ____ they reached a compromise.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. At the end of Q4, total revenue surged. 2. After months of negotiation, in the end they reached a compromise.'

Activity #22: Punctuality vs. Sufficient Time: 'In time' vs. 'On time'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Temporal prepositional distinctions | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Temporal Precision

Objective: Apply 'on time' (punctual according to schedule) vs. 'in time' (with enough time to spare) in project management.

Instructions: Draft two project management updates demonstrating the semantic difference.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. The project deliverable was completed on time, meeting the exact March 1st deadline. 2. We arrived at the airport in time to review our presentation slides before boarding.'

Activity #23: Causal & Transport Prepositions: 'Die of' vs. 'Die from' & 'By car' vs. 'In my car'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Prepositional constraints & article omission rules | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Prepositional Rule Application

Objective: Apply strict prepositional rules for cause of death (*die of an illness* vs. *die from an injury*) and transport modes (*by car* vs. *in my car*).

Instructions: Correct two news headlines containing prepositional errors.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. The victim died from malaria after a long illness. 2. The executive traveled by his private car.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. The victim died of malaria after a long illness. 2. The executive traveled in his private car.'

Activity #24: Adjacency vs. Addition: 'Beside' vs. 'Besides'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Prepositional vs. adverbial transition marker | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Additive vs. Spatial Prepositions

Objective: Distinguish spatial preposition 'beside' (next to) from additive adverb/preposition 'besides' (in addition to).

Instructions: Draft a market analysis sentence utilizing both words correctly.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Besides expanding our market share in East Asia, establishing a regional headquarters beside the financial exchange will streamline physical operations.'

Activity #25: Transitive vs. Intransitive Verbs of Motion: 'Lay' vs. 'Lie' & 'Raise' vs. 'Rise'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Transitivity & principal verb parts in business context | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Transitivity Audit

Objective: Master principal parts of transitive *lay/laid/laid* and *raise/raised/raised* vs. intransitive *lie/lay/lain* and *rise/rose/risen*.

Instructions: Edit four sentences in a corporate policy document for correct verb forms.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Prices have raised sharply. 2. Please lie the documents on the desk. 3. The report has laid unopened. 4. Revenues rose by 10%.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Prices have risen sharply. 2. Please lay the documents on the desk. 3. The report has lain unopened. 4. Revenues rose by 10%. (correct)'

Activity #26: Causation vs. Result: 'Affect' vs. 'Effect'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Verb vs. noun conversion & complex verb usage | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Affect/Effect Triad Application

Objective: Differentiate between 'affect' (verb: influence) and 'effect' (noun: result / verb: to bring about change) in executive correspondence.

Instructions: Draft three policy statements demonstrating all three distinct usages.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. Inflation will adversely affect consumer spending. (verb) 2. The new regulatory framework had an immediate positive effect. (noun) 3. The CEO managed to effect a complete organizational transformation. (verb: bring about)'

Activity #27: Commercial vs. Financial Nuances: 'Economic' vs. 'Economical'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Adjectival distinction in macroeconomic analysis | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Economic/Economical Disambiguation

Objective: Distinguish 'economic' (pertaining to the economy/trade) from 'economical' (thrifty/cost-effective).

Instructions: Complete two financial analyst statements with the correct adjective.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. The country faces severe _____ stagnation. 2. Switching to solar power proved to be highly _____ in the long run.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. The country faces severe economic stagnation. 2. Switching to solar power proved to be highly economical in the long run.'

Activity #28: Historical Significance: 'Historic' vs. 'Historical'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Adjectival precision in archivism & journalism | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Historic/Historical Precision

Objective: Distinguish 'historic' (momentous/famous in history) from 'historical' (concerning past events/documents).

Instructions: Audit a press release for correct adjectival selection.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Today we signed a historical treaty ending decades of tariff disputes, grounded in historic trade data from 1950.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Today we signed a historic treaty ending decades of tariff disputes, grounded in historical trade data from 1950.'

Activity #29: Sensory & Mental Perception: 'Sensible' vs. 'Sensitive'

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** False friend resolution & trait descriptors | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Perception Adjective Selection

Objective: Distinguish 'sensible' (practical/wise) from 'sensitive' (easily affected/perceptive/confidential) in management appraisals.

Instructions: Construct two employee evaluation statements using both terms accurately.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. Maria made a sensible decision to hedge our currency reserves ahead of the election. 2. As a manager, David is highly sensitive to team morale and handles confidential feedback tactfully.'

Activity #30: Spatial vs. Temporal Limitations: 'Farther' vs. 'Further'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Physical distance vs. metaphorical extension | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Distance vs. Extension Precision

Objective: Apply 'farther' (physical measurable distance) vs. 'further' (metaphorical progression, additional, or to advance).

Instructions: Edit an international expansion plan for precise usage of 'farther' and 'further'.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'We must travel further down the coast before opening the new hub. To further our market expansion, no farther investment is needed.'

Expected Output: Output: 'We must travel farther down the coast before opening the new hub. To further our market expansion, no further investment is needed.'

Module 4: Advanced Discourse Markers & Textual Cohesion (Practical English Usage)

Activity #31: Concession & Dismissive Discourse Markers: 'Mind You' vs. 'Anyway' vs. 'At Any Rate'

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Informal & formal concession markers in oral debate | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Concessive Discourse Markers

Objective: Deploy 'mind you' (qualifying a statement), 'anyway' (returning to main point), and 'at any rate' (setting a minimum boundary) in spoken discussion.

Instructions: Draft a dialogue between two board members discussing an acquisition bid.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'The target company has impressive IP. Mind you, their debt ratio is concerning. Anyway, we need to make a decision by Friday. At any rate, we shouldn't submit an offer above \$50 million.'

Activity #32: Additive Transitions in Executive Reports: 'Furthermore' vs. 'On Top of That'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Register-calibrated additive connectors | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Additive Register Calibration

Objective: Calibrate additive connectors across written formal reports (*furthermore*, *in addition*, *moreover*) and spoken meetings (*on top of that*, *what's more*).

Instructions: Convert an informal spoken complaint about vendor failure into a formal board memorandum.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Spoken: 'They missed the deadline. On top of that, they overcharged us for shipping.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Written Memo: 'The vendor failed to meet the stipulated delivery milestone; furthermore, they imposed unauthorized freight surcharges.'

Activity #33: Exemplification & Specification Devices: 'For Instance' vs. 'Namely' vs. 'Viz.'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Precision exemplification in academic prose | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Exemplification & Specification

Objective: Differentiate between 'for instance' (selective example among many) and 'namely' / 'viz.' (exhaustive listing of specific items).

Instructions: Complete two academic prose statements with the correct exemplification device.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Emerging markets, _____ Brazil and Indonesia, showed resilience. 2. Two board members voted against the proposal, _____ the CEO and the CFO.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Emerging markets, for instance Brazil and Indonesia, showed resilience. (selective) 2. Two board members voted against the proposal, namely the CEO and the CFO. (exhaustive listing)'

Activity #34: Summarizing & Concluding Devices: 'All in All' vs. 'In Short' vs. 'In Conclusion'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Register-appropriate summary markers | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Concluding Marker Selection

Objective: Match summary markers to format: 'all in all' (informal/balanced evaluation), 'in short' (concise summary), and 'in conclusion' (formal speech/paper ending).

Instructions: Select the appropriate concluding marker for three distinct text formats (a podcast recap, an executive summary, and an academic thesis closing).

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. Podcast recap: All in all, it was a volatile year for tech stocks. 2. Executive summary: In short, costs decreased by 12% while efficiency rose. 3. Thesis closing: In conclusion, the empirical data supports the original hypothesis.'

Activity #35: Punctuation for Text Cohesion: Semicolons, Colons & Em-Dashes

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Advanced discourse punctuation mechanics | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Discourse Punctuation Mechanics

Objective: Utilize semicolons (independent clause linking), colons (explanation/amplification), and em-dashes (parenthetical emphasis) in executive writing.

Instructions: Punctuate a raw run-on paragraph using semicolons, colons, and em-dashes.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Revenue surged in Q3 however profits remained flat the reason was simple unexpected supply chain disruptions.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Revenue surged in Q3; however, profits remained flat—the reason was simple: unexpected supply chain disruptions.'

Activity #36: Focusing Devices: 'As Far As...Is Concerned' vs. 'Regarding' vs. 'As For'

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Topic introduction & switching markers | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Focusing Device Structure

Objective: Apply focusing devices correctly, ensuring 'as far as [noun] is concerned' includes the necessary trailing verb phrase.

Instructions: Correct two common focusing device errors in meeting transcripts.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. As far as the new regulation, we are compliant. 2. As for the budget, we need a review.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. As far as the new regulation is concerned, we are fully compliant. 2. As for the budget, we require an immediate review.'

Activity #37: Balancing Points: 'On the One Hand' vs. 'On the Other Hand'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Paired contrastive signposting | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Contrastive Symmetry

Objective: Ensure strict structural symmetry when deploying 'on the one hand...on the other hand' without dropping the first element in formal writing.

Instructions: Re-draft a unbalanced contrastive paragraph into symmetrical formal argument structure.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft: 'The market offers high growth. On the other hand, political instability poses severe risks.'"

Expected Output: Output: 'Re-draft: 'On the one hand, the regional market offers unprecedented growth potential; on the other hand, persistent political instability introduces significant sovereign risk.'"

Activity #38: Reformulating Devices: 'In Other Words' vs. 'That Is to Say' vs. 'To Put It Bluntly'

Skill: Speaking/Writing | **Subskill:** Calibration of reformulation markers | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Reformulation Calibration

Objective: Select reformulation devices based on tone: 'in other words' (clarification), 'that is to say' (formal specification), and 'to put it bluntly' (direct frankness).

Instructions: Draft three reformulations of a corporate revenue downturn for different audiences.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. Shareholder memo (specification): Total yield contracted by 14%; that is to say, net margins fell to a three-year low. 2. Team briefing (clarification): We missed our target; in other words, we need to adjust Q4 expectations. 3. Executive crisis meeting (frankness): To put it bluntly, our current business model is losing money.'

Activity #39: Condition Specifiers: 'Provided That' vs. 'As Long As' vs. 'Unless'

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Contractual condition signposting | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Contractual Condition Framing

Objective: Deploy 'provided that' / 'providing that' (formal condition) vs. 'as long as' (informal/standard) vs. 'unless' (negative condition).

Instructions: Draft a contractual clause specifying payment terms upon milestone completion.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'The client agrees to disburse final payment within 30 days, provided that all software deliverables pass independent quality assurance testing; unless formal written objections are filed within this window, the release shall be deemed final.'

Activity #40: Dismissive Discourse Devices: 'Be That as It May' vs. 'Regardless'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Formal concessive dismissal in diplomatic speech | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Diplomatic Concessive Dismissal

Objective: Use 'be that as it may' (substantive concession followed by counter-assertion) in high-level debates.

Instructions: Respond diplomatically to a valid objection during a press conference.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Objection: "Your firm suffered severe reputational damage last quarter."'

Expected Output: Output: 'Response: "Be that as it may, our long-term fundamentals remain exceptionally robust, and investor confidence has fully recovered in Q3."'

Module 5: Common Advanced Learner Errors & Diagnostic Editing (Practical English Usage)

Activity #41: Auditing Double Negatives & Unintended Affirmations in Formal Prose

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Diagnostic error detection in negative constructions | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Negative Construction Audit

Objective: Diagnose and repair double negative errors (*scarcely no*, *without hardly*, *cannot help but*) in corporate communication.

Instructions: Audit and correct three sentences in an audit report.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. There was scarcely no evidence of fraud. 2. We cannot help but notice the error. 3. The team completed the audit without hardly any assistance.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. There was scarcely any evidence of fraud. 2. We cannot help noticing the error. 3. The team completed the audit with hardly any assistance.'

Activity #42: Resolving Misplaced & Floating Adverbs in Complex Sentences

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Adverb placement rules for 'only', 'even', and 'also' | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Adverbial Ambiguity Resolution

Objective: Position adverbs ('only', 'even', 'also') adjacent to the exact constituent they modify to eliminate semantic ambiguity.

Instructions: Differentiate three distinct meanings of a sentence by repositioning 'only'.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Base: "The CFO suggested selling the subsidiary yesterday."' (Insert 'only' in three positions)

Expected Output: Output: '1. Only the CFO suggested selling... (no one else suggested it) 2. The CFO suggested only selling the subsidiary... (did not suggest other actions) 3. The CFO suggested selling the subsidiary only yesterday. (happened recently)'

Activity #43: Subject-Verb Agreement After Disjunctive Conjunctions

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Agreement rules for 'neither...nor' and 'either...or' | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Disjunctive Agreement Precision

Objective: Apply the proximity rule for subject-verb agreement with 'neither...nor' and 'either...or' involving mixed singular/plural subjects.

Instructions: Select the correct verb form in four governance statements.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Neither the director nor the managers (was/were) informed. 2. Either the shareholders or the CEO (has/have) to sign.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Neither the director nor the managers were informed. (agreement with closest noun 'managers') 2. Either the shareholders or the CEO has to sign. (agreement with closest noun 'CEO)'

Activity #44: Correcting Unfulfilled Past Intentions: 'Was to Have Done'

Skill: Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Retrospective unfulfilled commitment structures | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Unfulfilled Retrospective Structuring

Objective: Construct and correct retrospective structures expressing unfulfilled plans (*was/were to have + past participle* or *was/were to + infinitive*).

Instructions: Transform a failed strategic merger announcement into a formal retrospective statement.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Planned: The merger was scheduled for June, but regulatory approval failed.'

Expected Output: Output: 'The merger was to have been completed in June, but regulatory intervention prevented final execution.'

Activity #45: Diagnostic Repair of Faulty Comparison Structures

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Illogical comparison repair in business analytics | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Illogical Comparison Repair

Objective: Identify and repair illogical comparisons (*comparing a company's revenue to a company*, *omitting 'that of'*).

Instructions: Correct two faulty comparison sentences in a competitive analysis report.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Our Q3 revenue was higher than our main competitor. 2. The salary of an executive is higher than a software engineer.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Our Q3 revenue was higher than that of our main competitor. 2. The salary of an executive is higher than that of a software engineer.'

Activity #46: Split Infinitives in Legal Register: Acceptability & Avoidance

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Style analysis & split infinitive recalibration | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Split Infinitive Recalibration

Objective: Evaluate split infinitives (*to radically restructure*), distinguishing between natural emphasis and formal legal prohibition.

Instructions: Provide two versions of a contract clause: (a) natural business prose with a split infinitive and (b) strict formal legal style.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Draft: "The company agrees to promptly pay all outstanding invoices."'

Expected Output: Output: 'a) Natural business style: The company agrees to promptly pay all outstanding invoices. b) Strict formal legal style: The company agrees to pay all outstanding invoices promptly.'

Activity #47: Erroneous Article Usage Before Abstract & Uncountable Nouns

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Determiner rules with abstract concepts | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Abstract Noun Article Audit

Objective: Correct erroneous definite article usage before abstract nouns used in a general sense (*the progress*, *the nature*, *the society*).

Instructions: Audit a sociology paper excerpt for zero article vs. definite article usage.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Audit: "The progress is essential for the human society to thrive in the harmony with the nature."'

Expected Output: Output: 'Correction: "Progress is essential for human society to thrive in harmony with nature."'

Activity #48: Correcting Prepositional Complementation After Verbs of Command

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Verb pattern rules for 'demand', 'insist', 'suggest' | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Command Verb Complementation

Objective: Ensure correct complementation patterns after verbs of command/suggestion (*insist on + gerund*, *demand that + subjunctive*, avoiding *demand to*).

Instructions: Correct three verb complementation errors in executive correspondence.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. The auditor demanded him to show the receipts. 2. She insisted to pay the bill. 3. I suggest him to resign.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. The auditor demanded that he show the receipts. 2. She insisted on paying the bill. 3. I suggest that he resign.'

Activity #49: Repairing Faulty Inversion After Restrictive Adverbials

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Inversion triggers with 'Only after', 'Not until', 'Seldom' | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Inversion Error Repair

Objective: Diagnose missing auxiliary inversion following fronted restrictive adverbials (*Only after*, *Not until*, *Under no circumstances*).

Instructions: Correct three inverted clause errors in a legal opinion.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Only after the audit was finished the board resigned. 2. Under no circumstances employees can share passwords. 3. Not until Q4 profits increased.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Only after the audit was finished did the board resign. 2. Under no circumstances can employees share passwords. 3. Not until Q4 did profits increase.'

Activity #50: Dangling Participle Repair in Technical Writing

Skill: Writing | **Subskill:** Participle subject alignment & modifier repair | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Dangling Participle Repair

Objective: Identify dangling participle modifiers and re-align them with the correct grammatical subject of the main clause.

Instructions: Repair two dangling participles in an engineering safety report.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Walking into the laboratory, the chemical spill was noticed. 2. Having completed the audit, the report was submitted by the team.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Walking into the laboratory, the inspector noticed the chemical spill. 2. Having completed the audit, the team submitted the report.'

Module 6: Advanced Prominence, Stress & Focus Placement (English Pronunciation in Use Advanced)

Activity #51: Tonic Prominence Placement: New vs. Given Information

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic focus on novel information in oral briefings | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Prominence & Information Structure

Objective: Place tonic prominence (nuclear accent) on new information while de-accenting given/repeated information in continuous spoken discourse.

Instructions: Mark the tonic syllable (CAPITALS) in a two-speaker corporate exchange.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'A: Are we holding the meeting in LONDON? B: No, we are holding the meeting in PARIS.'

Expected Output: Output: 'A: Are we holding the meeting in LONDON? B: No, we are holding the meeting in PARis. (given: 'holding the meeting'; new: 'Paris')'

Activity #52: Contrastive Stress Placement in Executive Keynotes

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Shifting tonic accent for explicit contrast | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Contrastive Stress Marking

Objective: Shift tonic prominence away from default final positions to highlight explicit contrast between choices in public speaking.

Instructions: Mark contrastive prominence in a keynote speech sentence comparing two strategic choices.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'We did not fail because of POOR MARKETING; we failed because of FLAWED PRODUCT DESIGN.'

Expected Output: Output: 'We didn't fail because of poor MARKeting; we failed because of flawed PRODUCT design. / We didn't fail because of POOR marketing; we failed because of FLAWED design.'

Activity #53: Prominence Shift in Compound Nouns vs. Adjective-Noun Pairs

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Stress patterns in lexical compounds vs. descriptive phrases | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Compound vs. Phrase Stress

Objective: Distinguish initial-element stress in compound nouns (*FINANCE committee*, *DATA center*) from final-element stress in adjective-noun pairs (*financial STABILITY*, *big DATA*).

Instructions: Read aloud and mark primary stress in four technical business terms.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. software developer 2. global expansion 3. cybersecurity 4. artificial intelligence'

Expected Output: Output: '1. SOFTware developer (compound) 2. global exPANSion (adj+noun) 3. CYbersecurity (compound) 4. artificial inTElligence (adj+noun)'

Activity #54: Stress Shift in Derivatives with Affixation

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Morphological stress shifts across word families | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Morphological Stress Shifts

Objective: Execute stress shifts correctly across derivational word families (*Econ-omy* -> *Eco-NOMIC* -> *Eco-NOM-i-cist*; *PHO-to-graph* -> *Pho-TOG-ra-phy* -> *Pho-to-GRAPH-ic*).

Instructions: Transcribe and produce the primary stress position for four derivative word series.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. CLimate -> cli-MAT-ic 2. Diplomat -> dip-lo-MAC-y -> dip-lo-MAT-ic 3. EXEC-utive -> ex-ec-u-TION 4. POL-i-tics -> po-LIT-i-cal -> pol-i-TI-cian'

Activity #55: Tonic Prominence in Multi-Word Verbs

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Phonological stress in phrasal vs. prepositional verbs | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Multi-Word Verb Accentuation

Objective: Place primary stress on the particle in phrasal verbs (*take OFF*, *set UP*) and on the verb in prepositional verbs (*LOOK at*, *APPLY for*).

Instructions: Mark the tonic accent in six multi-word verb statements.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. We need to set up the system. 2. Please look at the chart. 3. Don't back down. 4. They stand by their product.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. set UP the system 2. LOOK at the chart 3. back DOWN 4. STAND by their product'

Activity #56: Focus Placement in Cleft Sentences

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic alignment with syntactic cleft focus | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Cleft Sentence Prosody

Objective: Align tonic prominence with the syntactically focused element in *it*-clefts and *wh*-clefts.

Instructions: Mark nuclear stress in two cleft sentence utterances.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. It was the CEO who made the decision. 2. What we need is IMMEDIATE LIQUIDITY.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. It was the CEO who made the decision. 2. What we need is immediate liQUIDity.'

Activity #57: Prominence & Rhythm in Listed Items

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Pitch movement and prominence across multi-item lists | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Listing Intonation & Prominence

Objective: Deploy non-final rising tones on preliminary list items with a final falling tone on the ultimate item to signal list completion.

Instructions: Mark pitch direction (↑/↓) and stress on a 4-item board agenda.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Agenda: quarterly results, marketing budget, hiring plans, and legal updates.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Quarterly reSULTS (↑), marketing BUDget (↑), hiring PLANS (↑), and legal UPdates (↓).'

Activity #58: Stress Modulation on Auxiliary Verbs for Contrast & Affirmation

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Auxiliary accentuation for emphatic assertion | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Auxiliary Accentuation

Objective: Stress auxiliary verbs (*DO*, *CAN*, *HAVE*) to express emphatic contradiction or strong re-affirmation.

Instructions: Mark auxiliary stress in a diplomatic debate response.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'A: You didn't submit the report. B: I DID submit the report!'

Expected Output: Output: 'A: You didn't submit the rePORT. B: I DID submit the report! (emphatic auxiliary stress on DID)'

Activity #59: Prominence in Rhetorical Questions

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic focus in persuasive public speaking | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Rhetorical Question Prosody

Objective: Place tonic prominence on key persuasive constituents in rhetorical questions during executive presentations.

Instructions: Mark prominence in two keynote rhetorical questions.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Can we really afford to wait another quarter? 2. Who is truly driving innovation here?'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Can we really afford to WAIT another quarter? 2. Who is truly driving innoVAtion here?'

Activity #60: De-Accentuation of Echo Nouns & Synonyms

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic de-accentuation of repeated concepts | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Prosodic De-Accentuation

Objective: De-accent echo nouns, synonyms, and hypernyms when referring back to previously introduced concepts in oral discourse.

Instructions: Identify and de-accent repeated concepts in a continuous speech passage.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'We purchased new COMPUTERS yesterday. The MACHINES arrived this morning.'

Expected Output: Output: 'We purchased new compUTers yesterday. The machines arrived this morning. (de-accent 'machines' as echo noun for 'computers')'

Module 7: Discourse Intonation & Tonal Dynamics (English Pronunciation in Use Advanced)

Activity #61: Telling vs. Referring Tones: Fall (l) vs. Fall-Rise (V)

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Discourse intonation for shared vs. new knowledge | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Discourse Intonation Coding

Objective: Deploy falling tones (l) for presenting new, assertive information ('telling') and fall-rise tones (V) for shared, background information ('referring').

Instructions: Mark tone choice (l or V) on clauses in a corporate briefing.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'As you know (clause 1: shared), we opened a new office in Tokyo (clause 2: new info).'

Expected Output: Output: 'As you know (V referring), we opened a new office in TOkyo (l telling).'

Activity #62: Fall-Rise Tone for Reservations & Diplomatic Concessions

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic nuance in polite disagreement | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Fall-Rise Reservation Marking

Objective: Use the fall-rise tone (V) to signal incomplete agreement, polite reservations, or implied qualification.

Instructions: Produce two diplomatic spoken responses expressing partial agreement with a fall-rise tone.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Statement: 'The proposed merger will solve all our operational issues.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Response: 'Theoretically, it MIGHT (V fall-rise on 'might' signaling reservation)... but integration will take years.'

Activity #63: Rise-Fall Tone for Strong Agreement & Executive Approval

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic expressivity in high-impact speech | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Rise-Fall Intonation Expressivity

Objective: Apply the rise-fall tone (^) to convey strong conviction, surprise, or enthusiastic executive approval.

Instructions: Mark and produce rise-fall intonation on three executive endorsements.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Absolutely! 2. Brilliant idea! 3. Unquestionably.'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Ab-so-LUTE-ly! (^) 2. BRIL-liant idea! (^) 3. Un-QUES-tionably! (^)'

Activity #64: Intonation Patterns in Tag Questions: Certainty vs. Inquiry

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Pitch contour selection in tag questions | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Tag Question Prosody

Objective: Distinguish falling tags (\ seeking confirmation of known fact) from rising tags (/ seeking genuine information).

Instructions: Perform two tag questions demonstrating the contrast in intent.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. You reviewed the audit, didn't you? (seeking confirmation) 2. You reviewed the audit, didn't you? (genuine question)'

Expected Output: Output: '1. You reviewed the AUdit, didn't you? (\ falling tag = confirmation) 2. You reviewed the AUdit, didn't you? (/ rising tag = genuine inquiry)'

Activity #65: Pitch Movement in Asymmetrical Status Conversations

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Power dynamics & tone choices in workplace dialogue | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Status & Intonation Calibration

Objective: Analyze how senior executives use falling tones (controlling/assertive) while subordinates use fall-rise tones (referring/consultative).

Instructions: Perform a role-play transcript between a CEO and a Project Manager, applying status-appropriate intonation.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'CEO: We need the report by MONday (\ falling). Project Manager: As we agreed LAST week (V fall-rise), the team requires until WEDnesday (V fall-rise)...'

Activity #66: Pitch Movement in Conditional Clauses: Distinguishing Real vs. Unreal

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Intonation contours across conditional sentences | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Conditional Intonation Contours

Objective: Apply rising/fall-rise tones on the *if*-clause followed by falling tones on the result clause in complex conditional statements.

Instructions: Mark tone contours across three executive conditional statements.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'If we invest in R&D; now (clause 1), we will dominate the market by 2028 (clause 2).'

Expected Output: Output: 'If we invest in R&D; NOW (V fall-rise), we will dominate the market by 2028 (\ fall).'

Activity #67: Intonation for Polite Interruptions & Managing Floor

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic entry into ongoing boardroom debates | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Interruption Prosody

Objective: Use high-pitch rise-fall or fall-rise entry tones (*Excuse me*, *If I may*) to politely interrupt without appearing aggressive.

Instructions: Perform a polite spoken interruption during a simulated heated meeting.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'If I MAY (V high fall-rise entry tone), I'd like to clarify the financial figures before we proceed.'

Activity #68: Pitch Contours in Formal Announcements & Policy Statements

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Authoritative falling tone delivery | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Authoritative Intonation

Objective: Deploy authoritative low-ending falling tones (\\) on key informational units in formal press broadcasts.

Instructions: Read aloud a 3-sentence corporate press announcement with authoritative falling tones.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Good MORning (\\). Today, our board approved a strategic REstructure (\\). This initiative will ensure long-term STability (\\).'

Activity #69: Prosodic Irony & Sarcasm Recognition

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Attitudinal pitch range compression & flat intonation | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Prosodic Irony Modulation

Objective: Detect and produce prosodic irony using narrowed pitch range, prolonged syllable length, and unexpected flat intonation.

Instructions: Perform a sentence twice: (a) genuine enthusiasm vs. (b) dry prosodic irony.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Statement: 'That was a wonderful presentation.'

Expected Output: Output: 'a) Genuine: Wide pitch range, high onset, falling nuclear tone on WONderful. b) Ironic: Compressed pitch range, lengthened syllables, flat monotone on won-der-ful.'

Activity #70: Comprehensive Discourse Intonation Audit of a Recorded Speech

Skill: Listening/Speaking | **Subskill:** Full-scale transcription & intonation analysis | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Full Prosodic Audit

Objective: Audit a 1-minute audio passage, transcribing tonic syllables, prominence, and tone choices (\\, /, V, ^).

Instructions: Produce a full prosodic transcript of an executive keynote opening.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Ladies and GENTlemen (V), thank you for COMing (\\). TODAY (V), I want to talk about EFFiciency (\\)...

Module 8: Pitch Range, Key Shifts & Speech Chunking (English Pronunciation in Use Advanced)

Activity #71: High Key for Contrast & Topic Shift

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Pitch height adjustment for structural transition | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** High Key Transition Marking

Objective: Raise pitch height ('high key') on the initial tonic syllable of a new topic or contrasting point in public speaking.

Instructions: Mark high key (↑KEY) on a key transition in an executive presentation.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '...so that covers Q2 revenue. (Transition) NOW, let us turn to our Q3 PROJECTIONS.'

Expected Output: Output: '...so that covers Q2 revenue. ↑NOW (high key shift), let us turn to our Q3 proJECTIONS.'

Activity #72: Low Key for Parenthetical Asides & Oral Footnoting

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Pitch lowering for non-essential parenthetical information | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Low Key Parenthetical Delivery

Objective: Lower pitch height ('low key') and increase tempo for parenthetical asides, qualifications, or oral footnoting.

Instructions: Perform a speech excerpt incorporating a low-key parenthetical comment.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'The new factory in Poland—which was completed under budget—will open in November.'

Expected Output: Output: 'The new factory in Poland—[↓which was completed under budget—low key, faster tempo]—will open in NoVEMber.'

Activity #73: Tone Unit Chunking in Complex Academic Sentences

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Segmenting continuous speech into natural prosodic units | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Tone Unit Segmentation

Objective: Divide complex multi-clause academic sentences into digestible tone units (/) bounded by pauses and pitch resets.

Instructions: Insert tone unit boundaries (/) into a complex 35-word academic statement.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Although initial capital expenditures exceeded budget expectations the long-term operational cost reductions resulted in net financial gains within twenty-four months.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Although initial capital expenditures // exceeded budget expectations // the long-term operational cost reductions // resulted in net financial gains // within twenty-four months.'

Activity #74: Rhetorical Pausing for Impact in Keynote Addresses

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Strategic silent pauses following high-prominence statements | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Rhetorical Pausing Mechanics

Objective: Combine nuclear prominence with strategic silent pauses (1-2 seconds) to allow high-impact statements to settle with the audience.

Instructions: Mark prominence and pause durations ([pause]) in a persuasive speech climax.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'We didn't just meet our targets. We doubled them.'

Expected Output: Output: 'We didn't just meet our TARgets... [1.5s silent pause] ...We DOUBled them. [2.0s silent pause]'

Activity #75: Pitch Range Expansion for Public Speaking Engagement

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Vocal range modulation for audience engagement | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Pitch Range Expansion

Objective: Expand pitch range (utilizing higher peaks and lower baseline drops) to avoid monotone delivery in large-hall keynotes.

Instructions: Perform a 3-sentence product launch address using expanded pitch range vs. compressed pitch range.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Expanded range: Peak pitch on INnovative, drop to baseline on MARket, elevated pitch on TOday.'

Activity #76: Key Shifts in Executive Storytelling & Case Studies

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Narrative pitch shifts across background, climax, and lesson | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Narrative Key Shift Control

Objective: Modulate key across three narrative stages: neutral key (background), high key (climax/crisis), and low key (resolution/takeaway).

Instructions: Perform a 45-second corporate crisis case study utilizing key shifts.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Neutral key: In 2022, our primary data center failed. -> High key: ↑SUDDENLY, all regional servers went offline! -> Low key: ↓Ultimately, our backup protocols saved the firm.'

Activity #77: Pitch Reset After Parenthetical Interruptions

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Returning to baseline key after speech interruptions | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Pitch Reset Execution

Objective: Execute a pitch reset (returning to the pre-interruption baseline key and tempo) after completing a parenthetical aside.

Instructions: Perform a sentence containing a 10-word parenthetical clause, ensuring smooth pitch reset.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Baseline key: Our primary investor... -> Low key: (who, as you know, joined the board last month) -> Pitch reset to baseline: ...has approved the revised acquisition offer.'

Activity #78: Managing Turn-Taking via Pitch Level at Clause Boundaries

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic cues for yielding vs. holding the floor | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Turn-Taking Prosody

Objective: Use non-final rising/level tones at clause boundaries to hold the floor, and sustained low falling tones to signal floor completion.

Instructions: Demonstrate floor-holding vs. floor-yielding prosody in a business negotiation.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Floor holding: We have examined the contract (level tone -> continuing)... and regarding Clause 4 (level tone -> continuing)... Floor yielding: ...we accept the revised terms (low falling tone -> done).'

Activity #79: Pitch Contours in Executive Summary Delivery

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic structuring of bulleted executive summaries | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Executive Summary Prosody

Objective: Deliver a 3-point spoken executive summary using consistent high-onset key for each bullet point and low-falling completion on the final point.

Instructions: Read aloud a 3-point executive summary with structured key alignment.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Point 1: ↑FIRST, we expanded international sales. Point 2: ↑SECOND, we reduced overhead costs. Point 3: ↑THIRD, we launched our AI platform (↓ low fall).'

Activity #80: Pacing & Syllable Compression in Rapid Technical Disclosures

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Controlling tempo and articulation in dense disclosures | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Syllable Compression & Articulation

Objective: Compress unstressed structural syllables while maintaining crisp articulation on prominent technical terms during legal disclosures.

Instructions: Perform a 20-word legal disclaimer in 5 seconds without sacrificing intelligibility.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Compressed structural syllables: [subject-to-the-terms-and] PROMINENT: Con-di-tions of Clause 4B.'

Module 9: Connected Speech, Assimilation & Elision in Fast Delivery (English Pronunciation in Use Advanced)

Activity #81: Linking /r/, Intrusive /w/, and Intrusive /j/ in Continuous Speech

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Smooth vocalic transition across word boundaries | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Vocalic Linking Precision

Objective: Produce linking /r/ (*four hours* -> /fraz/) and intrusive /w/ (*two words* -> /tuwdz/) and /j/ (*media event* -> /midijevnt/).

Instructions: Transcribe and produce intrusive linking sounds in four continuous phrases.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Law and order 2. Go away 3. See it 4. Four engines'

Expected Output: Output: '1. Law /r/ and order 2. Go /w/ away 3. See /j/ it 4. Four /r/ engines'

Activity #82: Glottal Stop /ʔ/ Reinforcement and Replacement in Rapid Delivery

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Glottalization rules for syllable-final voiceless stops | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Glottalization Phonetics

Objective: Apply glottal reinforcement [t̚, p̚, k̚] before consonants (*network*, *statement*) and glottal replacement [ʔ] in informal rapid delivery.

Instructions: Distinguish formal unglottalized, glottally reinforced, and fully glottalized pronunciations of three corporate phrases.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '1. Great result -> [ret̚ rz̚lt] (formal) vs. [ret̚ rz̚lt] (reinforced) vs. [reʔ rz̚lt] (informal rapid)'

Activity #83: Regressive Place Assimilation of Final Consonants

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Consonant adaptation before labial & velar sounds | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Regressive Assimilation

Objective: Master regressive assimilation where alveolar stops /t, d, n/ adapt to following bilabials /p, b, m/ or velars /k, ɡ/ (*that boy* -> /ðæt bmp/, *good girl* -> /gud ɡml/).

Instructions: Transcribe phonetic changes caused by regressive assimilation in fast spoken business phrases.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Ten cars 2. Credit card 3. In main office'

Expected Output: Output: '1. /ten kmpz/ (n -> mp before k) 2. /krdi kmd/ (t -> k before k) 3. /m men fis/ (n -> m before m)'

Activity #84: Alveolar Stop Elision in Consonant Clusters

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Dropping /t/ and /d/ between consonants | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Consonant Cluster Elision

Objective: Apply elision rules dropping /t/ or /d/ when sandwiched between two consonants (*next week* -> /neks wi~~kt~~/, *hold tight* -> /h~~ldt~~ ta~~ht~~/).

Instructions: Identify and produce elided forms in five fast-paced corporate phrases.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Last month 2. First draft 3. Stand firm 4. Facts and figures'

Expected Output: Output: '1. /l~~st~~s m~~nth~~/ (elided /t/) 2. /f~~rst~~s dr~~ft~~/ (elided /t/) 3. /stæn f~~rm~~/ (elided /d/) 4. /fæks n f~~g~~z~~~~/ (elided /t/ and /d/).'

Activity #85: Weak Forms of Function Words in Rapid Spoken Prose

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Schwa reduction in structural words | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Weak Form Reduction

Objective: Reduce function words (*to, for, can, of, and, call*) to weak vowel forms (/t̬, f̬, k̬n, v̬, n̬/) during un-prominent speech segments.

Instructions: Transcribe strong vs. weak form pronunciations in continuous speech.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Statement: 'We can (/k̬n/) produce more for (/f̬/) the client than (/ð̬n/) before.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Weak forms: can -> /k̬n/, for -> /f̬/, than -> /ð̬n/. Strong forms only when stressed or isolated.'

Activity #86: Gemination Across Word Boundaries

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Sustained consonant articulation across identical boundary phonemes | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Consonant Gemination

Objective: Articulate geminated (doubled/lengthened) consonants across word boundaries (*substantiated data* -> /d̪̪/, *prime minister* -> /m̪̪/) without inserting a vowel pause.

Instructions: Produce five geminated business phrases cleanly.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Black cat 2. Bad day 3. Stop playing 4. Full list'

Expected Output: Output: '1. /blæk̪̪æt/ 2. /bæd̪̪eɪ/ 3. /stɒp̪̪leɪ/ 4. /fʊl̪̪lɪst/'

Activity #87: Coalescence of Alveolar Stops and Palatal Approximant /j/

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Coalescent assimilation in fluent speech | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Coalescent Assimilation

Objective: Master coalescent assimilation converting /t/ + /j/ -> /t̪j/ (*would you* -> /wɒd̪jə/, *don't you* -> /dɒnt̪jə/, *statute* -> /stæt̪jə/).

Instructions: Identify coalescent assimilation in four meeting phrases.

Task Prompt: Prompt: '1. Could you review this? 2. Not yet. 3. Did you see it?'

Expected Output: Output: '1. /kʊd̪jə/ 2. /nɒt̪jə/ 3. /dɪd̪jə/'

Activity #88: Stress Timing & Isochronous Rhythm in Spoken Prose

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Maintaining English stress-timed speech rhythm | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Isochronous Rhythm Control

Objective: Maintain stress-timed rhythm (isochrony) by compressing unstressed syllables between prominent beats in formal presentations.

Instructions: Practice tapping prominent beats while compressing intervening unstressed syllables.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'CATS EAT MICE vs. The CATS have been EATing the MICE.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Both sentences take equal spoken duration because prominent beats (CATS, EAT/EATing, MICE) dictate time intervals.'

Activity #89: Decoding Connected Speech in Rapid Boardroom Debates

Skill: Listening | **Subskill:** Aural comprehension of heavily reduced rapid speech | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Connected Speech Decoding

Objective: Transcribe rapid, native-speed audio containing assimilation, elision, and weak forms into standard written orthography.

Instructions: Convert a heavily reduced phonetic transcription back into formal written English.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Phonetic: /wɪl lʌts ɡoʊ ɒnd stɒp/ '

Expected Output: Output: 'Written: 'Well, let us go and stop.' / 'Well, let's go and stop.'

Activity #90: High-Speed Connected Speech Production of a Legal Disclaimer

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Integrating all connected speech phenomena into fluent delivery | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Integrated Connected Speech Production

Objective: Deliver a 30-second legal disclosure integrating vocalic linking, weak forms, elision, and gemination at native fast speed.

Instructions: Execute a high-speed production exercise with zero unnatural pauses.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Fluent rapid execution combining /r/ linking, weak form reductions, and elisions accurately.'

Module 10: Professional Voice Modulation, Accents & Pragmatic Prosody (English Pronunciation in Use Advanced & Practical English Usage)

Activity #91: Executive Voice Modulation: Floor Control & Turn-Taking

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic strategies for holding meeting attention | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Floor Control Prosody

Objective: Combine elevated volume, widened pitch range, and assertive falling nuclear tones to capture and hold floor control in competitive meetings.

Instructions: Perform an assertive floor-taking phrase during a simulated meeting interruption.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'If I could just STOP you there (\ high onset, assertive fall)... the DATA suggests a completely different conclusion.'

Activity #92: Prosodic Modulation in High-Stakes Q&A; Sessions

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Calm prosodic control under aggressive questioning | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Q&A; Composure Prosody

Objective: Deploy steady tempo, mid-key pitch onset, and controlled fall-rise tones to project composure during hostile media interrogations.

Instructions: Respond to an aggressive journalist's question using calm, controlled prosody.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Journalist: 'Isn't it true that your company covered up the product defect?'

Expected Output: Output: 'Response (calm mid-key onset, fall-rise tone): 'What IS true (V)... is that as soon as the issue was DIScovered (V)... we initiated a full voluntary REcall (\\).'

Activity #93: Navigating Accent Variation & International Intelligibility

Skill: Speaking/Listening | **Subskill:** Adjusting articulation for global audiences | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** International Intelligibility Adaptation

Objective: Adapt pronunciation parameters (moderating extreme local vowel shifts, avoiding hyper-rapid elision, clarifying tonic syllables) for international business English.

Instructions: Re-articulate an idiom-heavy local speech into clear, internationally intelligible global English.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Local: 'We're up against it, mate, gotta pull our socks up.'

Expected Output: Output: 'Global English: 'We face a significant challenge; consequently, we must increase our efforts immediately.'

Activity #94: Authoritative vs. Consultative Vocal Posture

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Prosodic framing of corporate directives | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Vocal Posture Calibration

Objective: Contrast authoritative vocal posture (low pitch baseline, terminal falling tones, steady tempo) with consultative posture (higher pitch onset, fall-rise tones, open pauses).

Instructions: Deliver a single directive in both (a) authoritative and (b) consultative styles.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Directive: 'We must finalize the budget by Wednesday.'

Expected Output: Output: 'a) Authoritative: Low pitch baseline, terminal fall on WEDnesday (\\). b) Consultative: Elevated onset, fall-rise on WEDnesday (V) signaling openness to discussion.'

Activity #95: Prosodic Signposting in Keynote Addresses

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Combining pauses, key shifts, and tone choices for speech structuring | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Keynote Macro-Signposting

Objective: Deploy macro-signposting: High key for main section heads, falling tones for key takeaways, and low key for transitions.

Instructions: Deliver a 1-minute keynote intro with full prosodic signposting.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: '↑FIRST (high key)... I'll review Q3 RESULTS (\\). ↑THEN... we'll examine FUTURE expansion (\\).'

Activity #96: Handling Floor Interjections Gracefully

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Diplomatic vocal deflection of interruptions | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Interjection Deflection Prosody

Objective: Deflect interjections using sustained level pitch tones and polite verbal formulas (*I will address that point shortly*).

Instructions: Perform a diplomatic deflection during a presentation.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'I appreciate that question (level tone)... and I will address that point directly in my closing remarks (low fall).'

Activity #97: Emotional Stance Modulation via Pitch Range

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Modulating emotional tone in executive messaging | **CEFR:** C1 | **Difficulty:** Advanced | **Type:** Emotional Stance Modulation

Objective: Modulate pitch range to project empathy (narrowed range, warm resonance, fall-rise tones) vs. urgency (expanded range, rapid tempo, sharp falls).

Instructions: Deliver an apology memo reading with empathetic prosody vs. urgent crisis response.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Empathetic: Narrowed range, slow tempo, fall-rise on REGRET. Urgent: Expanded range, fast tempo, sharp fall on Immediate.'

Activity #98: Vocal Fry vs. Resonant Projection in Corporate Presentations

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Vocal mechanics & breath support for professional voice production | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Resonant Voice Production

Objective: Diagnose and eliminate vocal fry (creaky throat resonance) by deploying abdominal breath support and full resonant chest projection.

Instructions: Perform a 3-sentence executive address ensuring full vocal resonance and zero creaky voice.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Full vocal resonance achieved via deep diaphragmatic support, maintaining crisp pitch stability through terminal falls.'

Activity #99: Pragmatic Prosody in High-Level Salary & Contract Negotiations

Skill: Speaking | **Subskill:** Strategic pitch modulation during monetary bargaining | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Negotiation Prosody

Objective: Use deadpan flat pitch on numerical counter-offers to project unyielding confidence, avoiding rising 'uptalk' tones that signal uncertainty.

Instructions: Deliver a salary counter-offer using firm, non-rising intonation.

Task Prompt: Prompt: 'Deliver counter-offer: 'My minimum requirement is \$180,000.'

Expected Output: Output: 'My minimum requirement... is one hundred and eighty thousand dollars. (low flat pitch, terminal low fall on 'dollars', zero rising uptalk)'

Activity #100: Comprehensive Prosodic & Usage Audit of a Recorded Keynote

Skill: Listening/Writing/Speaking | **Subskill:** Integrated usage and prosody critique | **CEFR:** C2 | **Difficulty:** Mastery | **Type:** Dual Usage & Prosody Audit

Objective: Perform a full dual audit of a 2-minute executive address, evaluating both usage precision (Swan criteria) and prosodic execution (Hewings criteria).

Instructions: Produce a 150-word written diagnostic critique covering both grammatical usage accuracy and intonation/prominence mastery.

Task Prompt: Execute the task as instructed.

Expected Output: Output: 'Audit Critique: The speaker demonstrated impeccable usage accuracy, correctly deploying 'as' for roles and avoiding register slip-ups. Prosodically, key shifts effectively signaled topic transitions, though terminal uptalk on financial figures weakened authority...'